

Rule 4: Ikhfa — Concealment

RULE: When Noon Sakinah or Tanween is followed by any of the 15 remaining letters (not covered by Izhar, Idgham, or Iqlab), the Noon is **CONCEALED** — partially hidden with a nasal hold of 2 beats.

The 15 Ikhfa Letters

All Arabic letters NOT in the other 3 rules:

Group 1	Group 2	Group 3	Group 4/5
Ta (t)	Tha (th)	Jeem (j)	Daal (d)
Dhaal (dh)	Zaa (z)	Seen (s)	Sheen (sh)
Saad (emphatic s)	Daad (emphatic d)	Taa (emphatic t)	Dhaa (emphatic dh)
Fa (f)	Qaaf (q)	Kaaf (k)	

How to Perform Ikhfa

- Step 1: Identify: Noon Sakinah followed by one of 15 letters
- Step 2: Do NOT pronounce full clear Noon (not Izhar)
- Step 3: Do NOT fully merge into next letter (not Idgham)
- Step 4: Hold a PARTIAL nasal sound for 2 beats
- Step 5: Your mouth/tongue moves toward the NEXT letter during the hold
- Step 6: Release naturally into the next letter

Ikhfa vs Idgham vs Izhar

Rule	Noon Sound	Nasal Hold	Letters
Izhar	Full clear Noon	No nasal hold	Throat letters
Idgham	No Noon at all — merges	2-beat nasal (with ghunnah type)	Yarmaloon letters
Ikhfa	Partial — in between	2-beat partial nasal	15 remaining letters

Quranic Examples

- Min Qabli (from before) — Noon before Qaaf → Ikhfa
- An Taquula (that you say) — Noon before Ta → Ikhfa
- Min Shay'in (anything) — Noon before Sheen → Ikhfa
- Innal Ladheena — subtle Ikhfa in the Noon before Dhaal

Complete Noon Sakinah Summary

- ★ Izhar: 6 letters (throat) — clear Noon
- ★ Idgham: 6 letters (Yarmaloon) — merge. With ghunnah: y n m w. Without: l r
- ★ Iqlab: 1 letter (Ba) — convert to hidden Meem
- ★ Ikhfa: 15 letters — conceal with partial nasal
- ★ TOTAL: $6+6+1+15 = 28$ = ALL Arabic letters. Every possible scenario is covered!